MAGIC MISSILE (5E, 2024 RULES) – DESCRIPTION

Level 1 – Evocation
Casting Time: Action · Range: 120 feet
Components: V, S · Duration: Instantaneous
Classes: Sorcerer, Wizard

You create **three glowing darts** of magical force. Each dart strikes a creature of your choice that you can see within range and deals **1d4 + 1 Force damage** to it. The darts all strike simultaneously, and you can direct them to hit one creature or several.

Higher-level slot: one more dart for each slot level above 1.

🎲 Quick summary:

1. You choose targets: visible, within 120 ft.
2. You split 3 darts (one target or several).
3. Each dart hits: no attack roll or saving throw.
4. 1d4 + 1 Force damage per dart.

⚠ Flaw in the rule and fixes Table rule

The text doesn't say how to handle concentration checks when several darts hit the same target. Fix: announce the rule before the game.

💡 Narrative option: Table rule

The DM can describe three glowing bolts streaking, curving, and striking without ever missing.

Step 1 – Choose targets:

You see creatures within range (120 ft). You split the darts: all on one target, or several.

Step 2 – Hit:

The darts strike with no attack roll or saving throw, all at once.

Step 3 – Damage:

Each dart: 1d4 + 1 Force damage.

Step 4 – Higher-level slots:

+1 dart for each slot level above 1.

Example: Eliot casts Magic Missile with a level 2 slot: 4 darts. He sends 3 at one goblin and 1 at another. Damage: 3 × (1d4 + 1) and 1d4 + 1.

⚠ Common questions:

Is an attack roll needed?
No: the darts hit automatically.

Can I target several creatures?
Yes: split as you like.

How much damage?
1d4 + 1 Force per dart.

How many darts?
Three, +1 per level above 1.

Must I see the target?
Yes.

Is a saving throw needed?
No.

What is the range?
120 ft.

⚠ Debate points and table options:

Table rule

Concentration
Each dart deals separate damage: one concentration check per dart? **Option**: one per dart; or one per spell (higher DC).

Shield
The *Shield* spell negates Magic Missile. **Option**: follow Shield; or negate only on the protected target.

Invisible target
You must see the target. **Option**: an invisible creature can't be targeted.

Deciding before rolls
Option: all darts are assigned before damage; or one at a time.

Counter-effect
Darts ignore AC. **Option**: keep as is.

⚠ Rule clarifications (answers found on the web, reworded):

Concentration and Temporary HP
Temporary HP absorb damage, but that damage still counts: the concentration save DC is based on the full amount taken (10 Temporary HP and 30 damage: DC 15).

Multiple darts
Each dart deals separate damage, so each can trigger its own concentration save.

These points remain open to discussion: your feedback is welcome to refine this sheet.

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